

30 CHAPTERWISE IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

English Language and Literature (184) | CBSE 2026-27

A Question of Trust

Footprints Without Feet | Board-examinable literature

30 original revision questions with answers: short-answer, competency, assertion-reason and long-answer practice. Set is based on the current syllabus and official question-paper style; it is not a prediction or an official CBSE paper.

Question 1

Why does Horace Danby consider himself respectable despite being a thief?

Answer:

He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. He separates this habit from his idea of being respectable, which the story exposes as self-deception.

Question 2

How does the woman in red trick Horace?

Answer:

She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. She uses his confidence and fear of being caught.

Question 3

Why is Horace arrested even though he believes he has escaped?

Answer:

He leaves fingerprints at the safe after removing his gloves to work. The woman takes the jewels and disappears, while the evidence points to Horace.

Question 4

What is the central idea or skill tested in A Question of Trust?

Answer:

The central focus is: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. This is the starting point for a strong answer from this chapter.

Question 5

Write two relevant points for a short answer based on A Question of Trust.

Answer:

First point: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. Second point: She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. Link the two points clearly instead of listing them without explanation.

Question 6

How does the first key idea in A Question of Trust lead to an important result or conclusion?

Answer:

Begin with the key idea: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. Then connect it to the result: She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it.

A Question of Trust - Continued

Question 7

What evidence, calculation, incident or concept best supports the first main idea in A Question of Trust?

Answer:

Use this supporting detail: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. He separates this habit from his idea of being respectable, which the story exposes as self-deception. The relevant detail should be stated before giving the final conclusion.

Question 8

Explain the importance of the second major idea in A Question of Trust.

Answer:

She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. She uses his confidence and fear of being caught. Its importance lies in showing how the chapter develops the topic beyond a simple fact or definition.

Question 9

What common mistake should a student avoid while answering a question from A Question of Trust?

Answer:

Do not give only a conclusion. Explain the reasoning with a correct detail, such as: He leaves fingerprints at the safe after removing his gloves to work.

Question 10

Compare the first and second important ideas in A Question of Trust.

Answer:

The first idea is: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. The second idea is: She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. A complete comparison states both the difference and the connection between them.

Question 11

Show a cause-and-effect link from A Question of Trust.

Answer:

Cause or starting point: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. Effect or outcome: She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. Use connecting words such as 'therefore', 'as a result', or 'thus'.

Question 12

What is the most useful sequence for explaining the main content of A Question of Trust?

Answer:

A clear sequence is: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. Next, She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. Finally, He leaves fingerprints at the safe after removing his gloves to work.

A Question of Trust - Continued

Question 13

Give a 40-50 word answer outline for an important question from A Question of Trust.

Answer:

Start with the direct answer: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. Add one supporting point: She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. End with the outcome or message: He leaves fingerprints at the safe after removing his gloves to work.

Question 14

How should you support an English literature answer from A Question of Trust?

Answer:

Use a relevant incident, character action, theme, or poetic image: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. Then explain what it reveals about the character, situation, or message.

Question 15

How can an examiner see that you understand, rather than memorise, A Question of Trust?

Answer:

Connect the idea to its reason or result. For instance: She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. Then explain why this point matters in the chapter's context.

Question 16

State one inference that can be drawn from the main situation or concept in A Question of Trust.

Answer:

A sound inference is that he leaves fingerprints at the safe after removing his gloves to work. This inference must be supported by a relevant point from the chapter.

Question 17

Frame a short competency-based response using the first two ideas in A Question of Trust.

Answer:

Apply the concept by first stating: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. Then justify the response with: She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it.

Question 18

What would make an answer from A Question of Trust incomplete?

Answer:

An answer is incomplete if it omits the explanation or final implication. Include both: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. Also add: He leaves fingerprints at the safe after removing his gloves to work.

A Question of Trust - Continued

Question 19

Prepare an Assertion-Reason style explanation based on A Question of Trust.

Answer:

Assertion: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. Reason: She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. Check whether the reason actually explains the assertion before choosing an option.

Question 20

How should you justify an answer from A Question of Trust in two clear steps?

Answer:

Step 1: state the concept or event - He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. Step 2: support it with the explanation or result - She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it.

Question 21

What answer structure is suitable for a 3-mark question from A Question of Trust?

Answer:

Use three connected points: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. He leaves fingerprints at the safe after removing his gloves to work. Keep the points specific and write them in a logical order.

Question 22

What answer structure is suitable for a 5-mark question from A Question of Trust?

Answer:

Give an introduction, develop these key points - He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. - and close with: He leaves fingerprints at the safe after removing his gloves to work. Add a diagram, equation, example, or textual reference where relevant.

Question 23

How can the ideas in A Question of Trust be applied to a new situation or case study?

Answer:

Identify the relevant principle first: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. Then use the chapter's reasoning to explain the case: She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it.

Question 24

Which detail from A Question of Trust is most likely to earn an extra mark when explained correctly?

Answer:

A useful detail is: He leaves fingerprints at the safe after removing his gloves to work. Explain it in context instead of using it as an isolated statement.

A Question of Trust - Continued

Question 25

Write a brief concluding statement for an answer on A Question of Trust.

Answer:

A suitable conclusion is: He leaves fingerprints at the safe after removing his gloves to work. This conclusion should follow naturally from the explanation rather than introduce a new point.

Question 26

Make a three-point revision note for A Question of Trust.

Answer:

1. He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. 2. She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. 3. He leaves fingerprints at the safe after removing his gloves to work. Revise these points with the chapter's examples, terms, and practice questions.

Question 27

How would you self-check an answer from A Question of Trust before submitting it?

Answer:

Check that you have answered the exact question, used the key idea - He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. - and supported it with a reason, example, calculation, or outcome such as: She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it.

Question 28

Why does A Question of Trust remain important for revision?

Answer:

It combines factual recall with explanation and application. The main takeaways are: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. He leaves fingerprints at the safe after removing his gloves to work.

Question 29

Create a final 60-80 word answer plan for a long question from A Question of Trust.

Answer:

Opening: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. Development: She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it. Conclusion: He leaves fingerprints at the safe after removing his gloves to work. Use complete sentences and include all required evidence, steps, or references.

Question 30

What is one last-minute revision question you should ask yourself about A Question of Trust?

Answer:

Ask: 'Can I explain why this is true or important?' A correct self-answer should include: He commits one planned burglary each year to fund his rare-book collection and avoids violence. and She pretends to be the house's owner, claims she has forgotten the safe combination, and persuades Horace to open it.

Sources: CBSE English curriculum 2026-27; CBSE Class X sample papers and marking schemes 2026-27; NCERT textbooks.